

ZIMBABWE SCHOOL EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL (style)
ACADEX PRACTICE EXAMINATION
O-LEVEL · ENGLISH LANGUAGE

ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1122/2
PAPER 2 November 2024

2 hours

PAPER 2 — READING — COMPREHENSION, SUMMARY, REGISTER — 2 HOURS

These are **original ACADEX questions** written to match ZIMSEC syllabus structure, mark allocations and command words. They are **not** leaked or copied official papers. This script is unique to November 2024 1122/2.

Additional materials: The passage is printed in this paper. Dictionaries may NOT be used.

INSTRUCTIONS: Answer all questions. Spend about 1 hour 30 minutes on Section A (comprehension and summary) and 30 minutes on Section B (register).

SECTION A (40 marks) — Comprehension and summary

PASSAGE

Peanuts and netballs<<
>><<
>>The idea began as a joke in the agriculture club. “If we roast peanuts, we can sell them at the gate and buy netballs,” said Blessing, who spoke as if every sentence were already a success. Nyasha, who preferred weighing things, asked about capital, hygiene, and the teacher on duty. The club laughed, then, because jokes that sit too long become plans, they stopped laughing.<<
>><<
>>They borrowed a pot from the Home Economics room and a tarpaulin from the groundsman, who said he would deny everything if the Head asked. On Friday they roasted until the air behind the laboratory smelled like a bus station kiosk. Nyasha kept a cash book. Blessing kept talking. A prefect threatened to report them for “informal trading,” a phrase he had heard his father use. Nyasha showed him the club minutes and the teacher’s signature. The prefect left, robbed of a speech.<<
>><<
>>By week three they had enough for one netball and a problem: boys from another stream wanted a “tax” for “security.” Blessing’s mouth opened. Nyasha closed it with a look and went to the sports teacher, not the bullies. The teacher walked with them to the gate the next Friday and bought a packet himself. The tax vanished like steam.<<
>><<
>>When the netball arrived, still smelling faintly of rubber and possibility, the girls’ team did not cheer as films had taught them to cheer. They tested the ball on the rough pitch, argued about who would play centre, and got on with it. Nyasha wrote in the cash book: Stock finished. Ball bought. Lesson: keep records, and do not pay tax to people who do not exist. Blessing, for once, had nothing to add, which Nyasha took as a kind of applause.

2. (a) What was the original purpose of roasting peanuts? [2]<<
>>(b) Contrast Blessing and Nyasha as club members. [4]<<
>>(c) How does Nyasha deal with the prefect and later with the “tax”? [4]<<
>>(d) Why is the groundsman’s remark humorous? [2]<<
>>(e) What does the team’s reaction to the new ball suggest? [4]<<
>>(f) Explain “people who do not exist”. [4] **[20]**
3. Summarise in not more than 160 words how the peanut project succeeds and the obstacles it meets. [20] **[20]**

SECTION B (10 marks) — Register · Answer ALL

4. You answer a landline in an office. The proper opening is: **[2]**

- A) Who is this?
- B) Good morning, Mutasa High School, may I help you?
- C) Yes?
- D) Talk, I'm listening.

5. At a funeral, a neighbour is grieving. You should say: **[2]**

- A) You'll get over it.
- B) Let's discuss the will.
- C) At least they were old.
- D) I'm sorry for your loss. I am here with you.

6. A visitor asks you for directions to the Head's office. The best reply is: **[2]**

- A) Why do you want the Head?
- B) Ask someone else, I'm busy.
- C) This way, please. I'll show you.
- D) Can't you read the signs?

7. Your friend has just failed a test and looks upset. The most appropriate comment is: **[2]**

- A) I told you you were lazy.
- B) That paper was easy, actually.
- C) Failure is your brand now.
- D) I'm sorry. We can go through it together if you want.

8. A librarian asks you to lower your voice. You say: **[2]**

- A) This is a free country.
- B) Other people are louder.
- C) Sorry, I'll be quieter.
- D) Make me.

END OF QUESTION PAPER

Worked solutions and mark-scheme notes are inside the ACADEX app (Extract & Study).